

BGV · OPERATOR PLAYBOOK · 8 MAY 2026

The Greatest Story Ever Told

Step-by-step actions for Olly to bring this to life.

Prepared by Ted (BGV)

For Olly Westmacott

Strategy doc [linked here](#)

Operating model — read this first

- **You are the operator.** Strategy, Substack writing, outreach, scheduling — that's you.
- **The editing team handles edits.** Audiobook clips, IG graphics, Big Church Read recuts, eventually actor-reading edits. You write the brief; they execute. You don't open CapCut.
- **Bear is patron, not host.** No new Bear filming. No new podcasts. Only existing-asset recuts.
- **Hodder framework is the source.** We're executing it in-house across BGV-owned channels.

01 Email Andy Lyon at Hodder Faith

15 MIN · WHY: THIS UNBLOCKS EVERYTHING. UNTIL RIGHTS ARE CONFIRMED IN WRITING, EVERY CLIP AND RECUT IS ON SHAKY GROUND.

1. Open your Outlook (Olly account).
2. Compose new email to Andy Lyon at Hodder Faith. Use the template below.
3. CC Bear's office if appropriate.
4. Send. File the reply when it lands.

COPY-PASTE · EMAIL TO ANDY LYON

Subject: GSET — confirming rights for BGV-owned channel use

Hi Andy,

Hope you're well. We're spinning up a BGV-owned engine to keep *The Greatest Story Ever Told* moving across the year — Substack, YouTube, Instagram, TikTok — all on channels we own and run in-house.

Before we kick off, I wanted to confirm in writing that BGV has the rights to:

1. Cut and publish short-form clips (30–60s) from the audiobook for use on BGV-owned social channels.
2. Recut and re-skin the Big Church Read 5-week guide as a BGV-branded "starter pack" PDF for churches, distributed via our landing page.
3. Produce in-house actor-led readings of selected chapters for YouTube long-form, with shorts repurposed across IG and TikTok.

Happy to share the rollout plan and cadence — we're aiming to start posting within the next two weeks.

Any approvals, restrictions or attribution requirements you'd like us to bake in, let me know now and we'll lock it into the brief.

Thanks Andy,
Olly

DONE WHEN Andy has replied confirming the three rights areas in writing.

02 Buy the domain

10 MIN · WHY: THE LANDING PAGE NEEDS SOMEWHERE TO LIVE. OWNING THE DOMAIN LOCKS THE BRAND.

1. Open Cloudflare Registrar (cloudflare.com → Domain Registration). Cheapest registrar, fastest DNS, no upsell rubbish.
2. Search availability in this order:
 - **greateststoryevertold.tv** (preferred — works for video-first positioning)
 - greateststoryevertold.co (fallback)
 - greateststoryevertold.org (fallback)
 - Note: .com is taken by the existing book site — do not try.
3. Add to cart. Pay (~£12/yr).
4. Auto-renew ON. Privacy/WHOIS protection ON (free with Cloudflare).
5. Forward the receipt to Felix for the BGV finance log.

DONE WHEN Domain is in your Cloudflare dashboard and resolving (a placeholder page is fine for now).

03 Claim handles + register Substack *(today)*

45 MIN TOTAL · WHY: HANDLE SQUATTING IS REAL. LOCK THE NAME EVERYWHERE BEFORE SOMEONE ELSE TAKES IT.

3a. YouTube channel — do this today

1. Open youtube.com. Sign in with the Google account you want to own this (recommend a fresh `greateststoryvertold@gmail.com` if you can claim it, otherwise BGV's existing brand account).
2. Top-right avatar → **Settings** → **Add or manage your channel** → **Create a channel**.
3. **Brand account name:** The Greatest Story Ever Told
4. **Handle:** `@greateststoryvertold` (fallback: `@thegreateststoryvertold / @gset.tv / @greateststory.tv`)
5. Skip the channel art for now — placeholder is fine. Editing team designs assets in week 1.
6. Channel description (paste below).
7. Save.

COPY-PASTE · YOUTUBE CHANNEL DESCRIPTION

The Greatest Story Ever Told — Bear Grylls' #1 Sunday Times bestseller, retold for a new generation.

Short clips, full readings, and the story behind the story.

Book: [amazon.co.uk/dp/\[insert ASIN\]](https://amazon.co.uk/dp/[insert ASIN]) · Newsletter: greateststoryvertold.substack.com

3b. Instagram

1. Sign up at instagram.com. New account (don't use your personal).
2. **Username:** `greateststoryvertold` (fallback: `greateststory.told / gset.book / greateststory_official`)
3. **Display name:** The Greatest Story Ever Told
4. Bio (paste below).
5. Profile image: book cover crop (placeholder — editing team replaces with brand asset week 1).

COPY-PASTE · IG BIO

The greatest story ever told.
Retold for a new generation by Bear Grylls.
#1 Sunday Times bestseller.
Get the book ↓

3c. TikTok

1. Sign up at tiktok.com.
2. **Username:** `greateststoryvertold` (fallback: `greateststory.told / gset.book`)
3. **Display name:** The Greatest Story Ever Told
4. Bio (paste below).

COPY-PASTE · TIKTOK BIO

Bear Grylls' #1 bestseller — read aloud, scene by scene.
Book in bio.

3d. Substack

1. Open substack.com → **Start writing**.
2. **Publication name:** The Greatest Story Ever Told
3. **URL:** `greateststoryvertold.substack.com`
4. **Tagline:** "The greatest story ever told, retold for a new generation. Weekly, every Friday."
5. About page — keep it short. One paragraph. Use the bio text above expanded by 2 sentences.
6. Custom domain: skip for now — point your bought domain (Step 2) at Substack later in week 2.

DONE WHEN All four handles claimed. Bios pasted. Profile placeholders are fine. Take screenshots of each for the BGV brand log.

04 Write Substack post 1: "Why this newsletter exists"

90 MIN · WHY: FIRST POST SETS THE TONE FOR EVERYTHING. GET THIS RIGHT AND THE NEXT 51 ARE EASIER.

SPECS

- **Length:** 600–800 words.
- **Publish day:** Friday. Lock this. Same day every week.
- **Image:** book cover at top. One inline image (atmospheric, scriptural — editing team can supply if you ask).

STRUCTURE

1. **Hook (1–2 lines).** A scene from the book, written tight. The kind of opening that makes someone keep reading.
2. **The promise (1 short paragraph).** What this newsletter will do for them.
3. **What's in the book (1 paragraph).** Pitch the book without sounding like a pitch. The 12-disciple structure, why Bear wrote it, who it's for.
4. **What this newsletter will be (1 paragraph).** Friday post. A clip or two. Reader stories. Occasional behind-the-scenes. Not a sermon, not a marketing list.
5. **Sign-off + CTA.** Buy the book. Forward this. See you Friday.

EXAMPLE OPENING LINE · KEEP, EDIT, OR REPLACE

"There's a moment in the book where Thomas — Ta'om — puts his hand into a wound, and the room goes quiet, and 2,000 years go quiet with it."

DONE WHEN Post is drafted, scheduled in Substack for Friday 9am UK, and you've sent yourself a test email.

05 Brief the editing team — first batch of audiobook clips

30 MIN (YOUR PART) · WHY: THE CLIP ENGINE IS THE FUEL FOR IG + TIKTOK. BRIEF ONCE, GET FIVE BACK, RUN THEM ACROSS TWO WEEKS.

WHAT YOU DO

1. Pull the audiobook source file location (confirm with Hodder if not already in your Drive).
2. Write the brief (template below).
3. Send to the editing team via the standard BGV brief channel.
4. Confirm receipt and timeline (target: 5 clips delivered within 5 working days).

THE FIVE TARGET MOMENTS (FIRST BATCH)

#	MOMENT	SOURCE CHAPTER
1	The crucifixion scene	Yohannan
2	The resurrection encounter	Maryam of Magdala
3	Thomas's doubt — hand in the wound	Ta'om
4	Peter's denial — three times before the cock crowed	Shimon
5	Mary's annunciation — "let it be done to me"	Maryam (mother)

COPY-PASTE · EDITING TEAM BRIEF — AUDIOBOOK CLIP BATCH 1

Project: The Greatest Story Ever Told — audiobook clip batch 1 (5 clips)

Source file: [Insert Drive link to audiobook MP3/WAV]

Deliverables: 5 vertical short-form clips

Spec per clip:

- Length: 30–60 seconds
- Aspect: 9:16 (1080×1920)
- Audio: audiobook narration, levels normalised to -14 LUFS
- Background: brand-aligned still image OR subtle atmospheric video loop (low motion, charcoal/cream/gold palette)
- Music: silent OR subtle ambient pad under narration (not louder than -24 LUFS)
- Text overlay: opening line of the scene at the top, animated in. End card with book cover + "Get the book — link in bio"
- Captions: burned-in, white on subtle drop shadow, Inter font

The five moments: [list above]

File naming: gset-clip-01-yohannan-crucifixion.mp4, gset-clip-02-magdala-resurrection.mp4, etc.

Delivery folder: [Insert Drive folder link — create /GSET/clips/batch-01/]

Deadline: 5 working days · **Approver:** Olly Westmacott

DONE WHEN Brief sent, receipt confirmed, delivery date agreed.

06 Build the landing page

3 HRS (ONE SITTING) · WHY: THIS IS WHERE EVERY CLICK ENDS UP. NO LANDING PAGE = NO EMAIL CAPTURES = NO COMPOUNDING.

RECOMMENDED PLATFORM: CARRD

Faster to ship than Squarespace. £19/yr Pro plan. Single page, unlimited sections. Mobile-perfect by default.

SECTIONS (TOP TO BOTTOM)

1. **Hero.** Book cover left, headline right.
2. **Buy buttons.** Amazon UK + Hodder direct.
3. **Substack signup form.** Embed via Substack's embed code.
4. **"How did this book reach you?" form.** Use Tally (tally.so — free). Embed iframe.
5. **For churches.** Headline + "Download the 5-week starter pack" PDF button.
6. **Footer.** BGV credit, contact email, social icons.

COPY-PASTE · HERO HEADLINE

The Greatest Story Ever Told

Bear Grylls' #1 Sunday Times bestseller — retold for a new generation, scene by scene.

COPY-PASTE · SUBSTACK SECTION

A new chapter, every Friday.

One short post, one clip, one moment from the book. Free, in your inbox, every week.

[email signup form]

COPY-PASTE · CHURCHES SECTION

For churches and small groups.

A free 5-week starter pack — designed by the team behind the book — to read it together with your community. Discussion prompts, weekly themes, leader notes.

[Download the starter pack — PDF, 12 pages]

TALLY FORM QUESTIONS

1. What's your name? (short text)
2. How did you first hear about the book? (multiple choice: bookshop / friend / church / podcast / social / other)
3. What's stuck with you? (long text)
4. Email (optional, if you want a reply)

DONE WHEN Page is live at your bought domain, all forms tested end-to-end, starter pack PDF is downloadable.

07 Lock the cadence

20 MIN TO SET UP · WHY: COMPOUNDING ONLY HAPPENS WITH CONSISTENCY. THE CALENDAR IS THE STRATEGY.

THE WEEKLY GRID

DAY	OUTPUT
Mon	IG/TikTok clip drop (audiobook clip 1 of week)
Tue	IG static post (quote graphic / audiogram / reader story)
Wed	IG/TikTok clip drop (audiobook clip 2 of week)
Thu	IG static post
Fri	Substack post + clip 3 of week + outreach hour
Sat	IG static post
Sun	Rest / scheduling buffer

SETUP

1. Open Outlook calendar.
2. Create recurring weekly event: "**GSET — Substack + outreach**", every Friday 9–10am UK.
3. Create recurring weekly event: "**GSET — clip & graphic brief to editing team**", every Monday 4–4:30pm UK.
4. Set 30-min reminders on both.

DONE WHEN Both recurring blocks are in your calendar with reminders.

08 Send 5 DMs to The Chosen fan accounts

45 MIN · WHY: THE CHOSEN AUDIENCE IS THE WARMEST TARGET AUDIENCE ON THE PLANET FOR THIS BOOK. LIGHT TOUCH, GENEROUS, NO PITCH.

CANDIDATE ACCOUNTS (RESEARCH AND PICK 5)

- @thechosentvseries (official — long shot but worth the DM)
- @chosen_fans
- @thechosen_clips
- @thechosenpodcast
- @chosennation
- @thechosenbts
- @thechosenshow.fans
- @chosen.daily
- Any UK-based fan accounts via #thechosen
- Pastors / leaders who post about The Chosen regularly

Pick 5 with real engagement (>1k followers, recent posts, replies on comments).

COPY-PASTE · DM TEMPLATE

Hey — love what you're doing with [account name].

Quick one: Bear Grylls just published a book that retells the gospel through the eyes of the 12 disciples — same emotional register as The Chosen, scene by scene, in their own voices. It's been #1 Sunday Times.

Genuinely think your community would love it. Happy to send you a copy on us if you want a look — just send me a postal address. No ask, no pitch, just thought you'd appreciate it.

— Olly (BGV / Bear Grylls' team)

DONE WHEN 5 DMs sent. Log who and date in `workspace/evidence/gset-outreach-log.md`.

09 Email 3 Christian podcasters

1 HR · WHY: ONE GOOD PODCAST HIT = THOUSANDS OF WARM LISTENS.
QUALITY OVER QUANTITY.

FIRST THREE TO PITCH

1. **Premier Christianity** — broadest UK Christian audience.
2. **Wild at Heart UK** — outdoorsy, masculine, Bear-aligned.
3. **Re-Enchanting (Justin Brierley)** — thoughtful, large reach, perfect tonal fit.

COPY-PASTE · EMAIL TO CHRISTIAN PODCASTERS

Subject: Bear Grylls' new gospel retelling — would [Show name] want first crack?

Hi [host name],

Big fan of [specific recent episode — name it]. Quick pitch.

Bear Grylls just published *The Greatest Story Ever Told* — a retelling of the gospels through the eyes of the 12 disciples, in their own voices. Hodder Faith, #1 Sunday Times, out now.

I'm running the engine for it from Bear's side — Substack, clips, the lot. Before we get loud with it, I wanted to offer you first crack: an early conversation with Bear (audio is realistic, video harder), or if Bear's diary is the bottleneck (it usually is), a deep-dive with me on how the book came together and why it's landing the way it is.

I'll send you a copy regardless — drop me a postal address.

Sample audiobook clip (60 sec): [link to a Drive-hosted clip from Step 5]

Thanks [host name],

Olly Westmacott

BGV

DONE WHEN 3 emails sent. Log in `workspace/evidence/gset-outreach-log.md`.

10 Block the weekly hour

ALREADY DONE IF STEP 7 IS DONE · WHY: DISCIPLINE REMINDER. THE CADENCE BREAKS THE MOMENT FRIDAY GETS EATEN.

Friday 9am–10am, every week, immovable. The agenda:

1. Write Substack post (45 min).
2. Confirm clips queued for the week with editing team (5 min).
3. Send 5 outreach messages — DMs or emails (10 min).

If a Friday gets eaten, move it to Thursday. Do not skip a week.

DONE WHEN It's been four consecutive Fridays.

11 Pentecost (24 May 2026, ~16 days out)

PLAN NOW (30 MIN), EXECUTE ON THE DAY · WHY: FIRST CALENDAR ANCHOR. THE PATTERN YOU SET HERE REPEATS ANNUALLY.

1. **Editing team brief (send by 17 May):** "Story doesn't end at resurrection" clip from the audiobook's final scenes (Acts/Pentecost-adjacent passages — Holy Spirit, Ascension chapters). 60-second vertical, same spec as Step 5.
2. **Substack post (publish 22 May, Friday):** Title — "The story doesn't end at resurrection." 600–800 words on the Holy Spirit / Ascension chapter. Tease the clip. Drop it.
3. **Bear's existing channels (optional):** ONE calendar-anchored post on Bear's IG. BGV team writes and posts on his behalf. Keep minimal — Easter and Christmas are the only two annually where Bear's channels carry weight; Pentecost is a soft touch.

DONE WHEN Clip published Mon 25 May, Substack post live 22 May, Bear's IG post (if happening) approved by Bear's office and scheduled.

12 1-year UK pub anniversary (19 Jun 2026)

90 MIN FOR THE POST · WHY: ANNIVERSARY CONTENT COMPOUNDS — EVERGREEN, SHARABLE, GIVES READERS A REASON TO FORWARD.

1. **Substack post:** "365 days since The Greatest Story Ever Told — what readers told us."
2. **Source material:** Pull responses from your Tally form (Step 6). Quote 5–8 readers.
3. **If volume is thin:** Pad with Amazon review screenshots — 4–5 of the best ones, screenshotted clean.
4. **Editing team brief:** A "reader stories" Reel — 60 seconds, quotes overlaid on atmospheric backgrounds, narrated by Olly or kept silent with text-only.

DONE WHEN Substack post live 19 June, Reel published same day.

13 Q3 (Jul–Sep) — commission first actor reading

2 WEEKS PLANNING · 1-DAY SHOOT · WHY: LONG-FORM PLAY. YOUTUBE WANTS 10+ MINUTE VIDEOS. HIGHEST-LEVERAGE PIECE YOU CAN PRODUCE.

1. **Pick the chapter.** Yohannan or Maryam of Magdala. Both are emotional peaks. Maryam first is a strong contender — under-represented voice, biggest payoff.
2. **Cast.** Brief BGV's casting contacts. Looking for: stage/screen actor, mid-30s to mid-50s, capable of carrying 15 min of solo reading. Budget: **£800–1,500 day rate**.
3. **Shoot.** Single day. Quiet room (acoustic-treated if possible — book a podcast studio if not). Camera + good mic + soft warm light. Director (Olly or BGV producer).
4. **Edit.** Editing team cuts to ~10–15 min for YouTube long-form. Three vertical shorts cut from the same footage for IG/TikTok.
5. **Promote.** Substack post on day of release. Three short-form pieces over the following week.

REALISTIC BUDGET FOR FIRST ONE

£2,000–£4,000 all-in (actor + studio + editing). Subsequent ones get cheaper as the format and team mature — target **£1,500** by reading 4.

DONE WHEN First actor reading published on YouTube, three shorts published over the following 7 days.

14 Q4 (Nov–Dec) — launch Give One Away campaign

4 WEEKS BUILD · 4 WEEKS CAMPAIGN · WHY: CHRISTMAS GIFTING IS THE BIGGEST SALES WINDOW. THE GIVE ONE AWAY FRAME TURNS BUYERS INTO MULTIPLIERS.

1. **Editing team brief (mid-Oct):** Design bookplates / gifting cards. Print-ready PDF + digital share assets.
2. **Substack push (1 Dec onwards):** Three posts across Advent — "Why give the book this Christmas," "The story behind a scene," "Last call."
3. **IG push (1 Dec onwards):** Daily Advent calendar — one short clip or quote per day from 1–24 Dec.
4. **Bulk church order push:** By Q4, Steps 6 (landing page churches section) and 9 (podcaster outreach) should have warmed church partnerships. Email all church contacts a bulk-order offer (e.g., 10 books + bookplates for £X).
5. **Christmas content on Bear's channels:** ONE Christmas Eve post on Bear's IG. BGV team writes, Bear approves.

DONE WHEN 24 Advent IG posts published, 3 Substack posts published, bulk church offer sent to all collected church contacts, Bear's Christmas Eve post live.

Next 7 days

This is what you do this week. Nothing else matters until these are done.

- ☐ **TODAY · DAY 1** Email Andy Lyon (Step 1). Buy domain (Step 2). Create YouTube channel (Step 3a).

- ☐ **DAY 2** Claim IG, TikTok, Substack handles (Steps 3b–3d).

- ☐ **DAY 3–4** Draft Substack post 1 (Step 4). Send brief to editing team for first 5 audiobook clips (Step 5).

- ☐ **DAY 5 · FRIDAY** Lock recurring calendar blocks (Step 7). Publish Substack post 1 at 9am.

- ☐ **DAY 6–7** Build landing page (Step 6). Test all forms.

- ☐ **THEN NEXT WEEK** Outreach (Steps 8 + 9). Then Pentecost prep (Step 11).

Strategy doc: <https://dnd5fj5gjy-bit.github.io/bgv-gset-self-execution-plan/>

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